

Chapter 34 - Part 6

Xu Qingzhu sat in the study thinking, trying to connect all the threads, but she knew too little to arrive at the truth. She only had vague suspicions deep in her heart.

And it was a very unreliable suspicion.

She felt that Liang Shi wasn't Qiu Zimin's daughter.

According to general logic, Liang Shi should be a daughter that Father Liang brought back from outside and fostered under Qiu Zimin's name. So Qiu Zimin treated her with all kinds of kindness, but with only one purpose: to ruin her.

Ruining a person was simple—you just needed to indulge them when they were young and ignorant, and encourage them when they did bad things. They would definitely not establish correct values, just like the previous Liang Shi.

What about the current Liang Shi?

Had another personality within her body awakened, starting a completely different life from before?

Xu Qingzhu had already researched a large amount of psychiatric literature online to understand dual personality and investigate what multiple personality disorder was really like.

Online information showed that people with multiple personalities would have a process of personality alternation, which could be long or short. Xu Qingzhu had consulted Zhao Xuning about this.

Zhao Xuning was silent for two seconds, then said sarcastically: "Before that hospitalization, she was always that terrible person."

So Liang Shi's personality alternation was completed during that time.

There had been no such problems before, and there had been no new personality alternations afterward.

But could personality alternation make someone's eyes, scent, and behavior completely change?

There had been such cases before.

Zhao Xuning told her there was no need to reach a conclusion so early. It might not be personality alternation, but some kind of supernatural phenomenon.

But Xu Qingzhu, an atheist and firm believer in materialism, didn't believe that. She was more inclined to think this was a mental illness.

But mental illness and psychological problems all required the patient's active cooperation to be diagnosed and treated, unless they were particularly insane—crazy enough to endanger public safety, where you could tell at a glance that they were mentally ill.

Otherwise, there was no way to confirm it.

Given Liang Shi's current state, if Xu Qingzhu insisted she had a mental illness, Liang Shi might turn around and wonder: Are you the one with a mental illness?

Then it would become two people accusing each other.

The matter seemed to have reached an unsolvable situation.

Xu Qingzhu had even created a document, trying to analyze it with her rational and intelligent mind, but due to lack of evidence and necessary conditions, she couldn't reach a conclusion. So she had invited Dr. Gu Jun'ru¹ to come.

As a psychiatrist with many years of practice, Dr. Gu Jun'ru had rich diagnostic experience and should be able to see something.

Xu Qingzhu could only place her hopes on Dr. Gu.

After thinking for a long time in the study, the more she thought about it, the more she felt there were too many mysteries surrounding Liang Shi. She couldn't help wanting to discuss it with someone, but going through her contacts, the only person she could discuss this with was Zhao Xuning.

So she messaged Zhao Xuning: [Yesterday Liang Shi made dumplings.]

Zhao Xuning: [...]

This string of ellipses seemed to say—what does this have to do with me?

Xu Qingzhu: [Today she was playing with her niece. Her niece used to be very afraid when she saw her.]

Zhao Xuning: [She really has changed. She even likes children now.]

Xu Qingzhu: [So I find it strange.]

Zhao Xuning: [What do you find strange?]

Xu Qingzhu: [...Don't you find it strange?]

Zhao Xuning didn't reply for a while, then finally sent a voice message: "Don't you think you're the one being strange now?"

Xu Qingzhu: [?]

Zhao Xuning: "You're too curious about her affairs. This version of you seems even stranger."

Xu Qingzhu: [...]

Xu Qingzhu wasn't convinced and replied with voice: "That's because you don't live with her. You'd have your worldview refreshed every day, every moment."

Zhao Xuning said casually: "Then just consider her to have a dual personality. Take advantage of her being reasonable now to divorce quickly. Don't drag it out until the other personality returns—that would be hard to handle."

Xu Qingzhu stared at the screen for a long time, as if struck by lightning.

It was as if some blunt instrument had heavily struck her head, and in an instant, everything became clear.

"From a psychological perspective, being excessively curious about and focused on someone can very likely lead to developing feelings," Zhao Xuning said.

Xu Qingzhu pressed her forehead and exhaled lightly, then messaged her: [I understand.]

"But I don't mean to advise you to divorce," Zhao Xuning said. "You consider it yourself. I'm just making a suggestion. And my cousin said she has very strong acting talent, so... I also suspect she might be acting now."

Xu Qingzhu got new information: "Acting talent?"

If she remembered correctly, Zhao Xuning's cousin was the famous actress Zhao Ying.

"Yes. Did Liang Shi tell you?" Zhao Xuning laid out everything Zhao Ying had told her that day, and finally summarized: "My cousin said Liang Shi's acting talent is so strong that with time, she could crush her."

This was too ridiculous!

Zhao Ying was an actress-level figure!

The year she descended into the entertainment industry, she was called "the Purple Star descending to earth"², directly causing a major reshuffle in the entertainment industry.

And what about Liang Shi?

An idle rich girl.

This was simply nonsense.

But Zhao Ying had no need to make things up.

Footnotes:

¹ Dr. Gu Jun'ru: A psychiatrist character who will be introduced to help analyze Liang Shi's condition

² Purple Star descending to earth: A Chinese expression referring to an extraordinarily talented person appearing, as if a celestial star had come down to the mortal world